

Vacations & Travel

“I’d have a passport full of stamps more than a house full of collections”

- An Instagram favourite

Travel can be approached from 2 important dimensions

1. Date of travel
2. Length of travel

If your work permits only weekend trips, not much planning is necessary. Sign up for weekend fares from your location on Skyscanner and it will send you the fares in a bundled email every Monday. Also, sign up for emails from SpiceJet, GoAir, Indigo, AirAsia, Scoot and every budget airline as to make travel plans when there’s a price war. Use unroll.me and bundle all travel emails into a single mail received during a convenient time of the day. Or better, set up a separate mailing account such as pranavtravel@gmail.com and login before you go to sleep.

But let’s say you’re ball to a big-ass vacation. Now, this needs planning on several fronts. It is paramount to reduce big expenses so you get to travel frequently for longer time-periods. In fact, I often get the urge to stand up and ask aloud ‘*How much did you pay for your ticket?*’ mid-air to thrash any insecurities. But the risk of being banned from flying made me go through a peaceful alternative and I buried myself in research on the mistakes we make, so I would not make them. Here’s a few:

Why is travel expensive? Mistakes we do

- 1) **Approach travel with the dates first:** Our decision to travel is often catalogued by the number of national holidays attached to the weekend or the exam holidays of our siblings or children. When a large number of people think the same way, prices reflect the seasonal demand.

What to do instead: The dates to travel will be the last thing you decide after spotting a sale or discount prices. They often occur 6-9 months in the